

Basing deal keeps Greenland as minimal risk to transatlantic ties

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【メール原文】

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While the text of the new agreement is not final, it is reported to guarantee many of the same key points of the existing 1951 and 2004 US-Greenland-Denmark defense agreements, including basing and overflight rights. These rights are expanded, however, to endure if Greenland becomes an independent nation, and to allow US construction outside of previously defined defense areas.

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Beyond the topline items, the agreement also reportedly will contain language restricting third-country basing access and standing up strategic investment screening including into Greenland's burgeoning critical minerals sector. As the details of the agreement are to be set officially, the exact legal structure of future investment screening will be a watchpoint to gauge the agreement's durability and enforceability moving forward.

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The agreement aligns with our longtime view that the Greenland issue posed minimal risk to the transatlantic relationship, which we view as likely to remain stabilized at a low, but not worsening, ebb through the remainder of the Trump term. (For more, please see [Transatlantic relations inch back from the precipice](#) , 9 September 2026.)

Fed report sets up pretext to fire Barr. We expect the White House will move to fire Fed governor Michael Barr in the next several weeks (70% odds) over allegations that he mismanaged the central bank's supervisory responsibilities leading up to the collapse of Silicon Valley Bank in 2023.

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Fed Vice Chair for Supervision Michelle Bowman released the preliminary conclusion of the new report into the SVB collapse on Friday, well ahead of the promised year-end deadline. That suggests an accelerated timeline that would allow the White House to create and fill a vacancy on the Board during this Congress.

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The firing will have more political and legal legitimacy than did the firing of Lisa Cook last year. The administration has more plausible “cause” over Barr—allegations against whom revolve around his conduct in office—than against Cook. However, the administration will still need to clear the ambiguous bar the Supreme Court set earlier this year for adequate “process” in firing a Board member. Should Barr decide to contest the firing, it could be blocked by a lower court, and a key question will be whether Barr can remain in office while the courts adjudicate his claim.

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We do not see a firing as affecting the course of monetary policy. The White House will continue to give Chair Kevin Warsh room to respond to economic conditions, and material changes in Fed policy are unlikely to be affected by a single seat change. That means the Fed’s current tightening cycle will not be altered.

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For more, please see Fed report sets up pretext for White House to fire Barr , 19 September 2026.

Positive optics the likely major US-China summit outcome. Both the US and China see positive optics and pledges of future leader-level engagement as the major outcomes from Chinese President Xi Jinping’s visit to Washington on 23-26 September.

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The visit will be a “success” because it will extend the current period of US-China non-hostility. Senior officials in Beijing indicated to Eurasia Group that their top goal is to advance the leaders’ personal relationship. The two sides are thus set to agree on small wins that do little to address the substantive points of friction in the relationship between the countries.

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On tariffs, we expect the Board of Trade discussion to result in tariff reductions on select goods—US agriculture and energy and Chinese manufacturing inputs—even as Section 301 tariffs are likely to increase following the summit. On export controls, we expect a six-month extension of the export control truce, but it might occur closer to the 10 November expiration date due to frictions over rare earths.

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Breakthroughs on AI are unlikely, given mutual distrust and Trump’s skepticism of AI safety concerns, but both sides might establish a workplan for future AI discussion. Expect tart exchanges on Iran and Taiwan in private; Taiwan is unlikely to be a major agenda item, as China sees the May summit as having made significant process on the issue.

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For more, please see Summit “success” through incremental deliverables that prevent deterioration of ties , 21 September 2026.

Quote of the Day

“The same Hispanics who helped [Trump] get to the White House in 2024 feel betrayed today.” – Rep, Maria Elvira Salazar (R-FL), in a new TV ad in Miami-Dade County in Florida. Salazar’s diagnosis of

Republicans' political problem is correct: Collapsing support among Hispanic voters in particular is a major threat to Republicans nationwide, and especially in the disproportionately Hispanic state of Texas, where the Republican Senate candidate Ken Paxton has consistently trailed in the polls (see The GOP's 2024 coalition is collapsing , 15 September 2026).

On the Radar

18-28 September: High-Level Week at UN General Assembly

24 September: Trump-Xi summit

2 October: Last day Senate is in session before midterms

3 November: National midterm elections

10 November: US-China tariff truce expires

18-19 November: APEC leaders meeting in China

11 December: Government funding runs out

14-15 December: G20 summit in Florida

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